

Firsts Fund helps early-career Filipinos invest for the big “firsts” five or more years away (taking Mom and Dad abroad, a first car, a first home, a first business) by owning, from ₱100, the companies around the world that run the services everyday life depends on.

₱100 to start and per top-up (proposed)	31 companies in 14 markets, held directly	1.50% a year, one fee (proposed)	5+ years recommended horizon, not a lock-in	Pesos every key number shown in pesos, not just %
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THE PROBLEM

At 22, your biggest asset is not money. It is forty years of future pay: in pesos, tied to one economy, impossible to sell. A young Filipino already depends almost entirely on the Philippines, without ever choosing to. Then look at what is easy to buy: savings and money-market funds that park the money, the local stock index that adds even more Philippine exposure, or crypto. Two doors, **park or gamble**, and the middle, where a long-term goal belongs, is empty.

Access is no longer the problem. BPI cut its UITF minimum from ₱10,000 to ₱1,000 in 2023; some platforms start at ₱50. PSE accounts rose 50.1% in a year, and 26.5% now belong to 18-to-29-year-olds. Young Filipinos are arriving. What has not changed is what they find when they arrive.

“Number one: you have to get global exposure... by diversifying some of that local exposure, you’re actually lowering your volatility.” — Joaquin Rossano U. Veluz, Sun Life Investment Management and Trust Co.

WHY A SAVER SHOULD THINK ABOUT RISK DIFFERENTLY

Most risk questions are built to protect a balance you already have, which is right for someone living off their savings. A young saver does the opposite: they add money every month. **For them, a fall early on means buying more units at a lower price.**

We tested it. We took the fund's own 60 monthly results and shuffled their order 20,000 times, so the total return stays the same and only the timing changes. How much a strong first half helped the final amount:

Someone saving ₱1,000 a month	it hurt: −0.85 (strongly negative)
Someone withdrawing ₱900 a month	it helped: +0.85 (strongly positive)

Same returns, opposite outcomes. This does not mean falls are good; a fall that never recovers hurts everyone. It means a saver with years to go should not be judged by the same yardstick as a retiree.

WHAT THIS MEANS FOR THE FUND

Success is people still saving in year five. Contributions decide where a young saver ends up, so everything in how people find the fund (page 2) and how they use it (page 3) is built to keep them going.

Numbers in pesos. “−27%” means little to a first-jobber; “₱1,363 on a ₱5,000 balance, about six weeks of saving” does. We show the peso figure next to every percentage that matters.

THE FUND

The proposed **Firsts Fund** is a peso UITF that owns, directly, 31 listed companies around the world that run essential, hard-to-replace services: power and water, phone and internet networks, ports, airports, hospitals, and the equipment behind them. **₱100 to start. One fee. No fund-of-funds layer.**

Chosen by our M · V · P framework:

M · Map	Find essential-service companies worldwide: 140 screened, 129 fit the theme
V · Verify	Debt stress test and value and quality against peers: 49 pass
P · Position	Add only what improves diversification, size by risk: 31 held

Same published rules for every company, including the Philippines' ICTSI. Full process on page 5.

25.0% vs 10.0%
a year over the past 5 years: today's holdings (hindsight) vs the benchmark, NFRA global infrastructure ETF

18.7%
holdings without chip and grid-equipment makers, same 5 years

12.0%
a year over 36 years, industry-level history

Read honestly. The companies were picked in 2026 and tested backwards, so 25.0% is a best case, not a forecast. The two lower numbers are the checks: the result does not rest on chipmakers, and over 36 years the approach grew about as fast as the world market (12.2%) with a worst year of −27%. Expect market-like growth from businesses people cannot do without.

HOW IT COMPARES WITH WHAT IS AVAILABLE TODAY

Product	What it is; minimum	What it does not solve
Money market fund	Short-term debt; ₱50–1,000	Safe, but likely to trail rising prices over five years.
Pag-IBIG MP2	Government savings; ₱500	Tax-free and never negative. Better for a first 3–5 years away; we point people there.
Local stock index fund	PSEi shares; ₱1,000	Adds more of the Philippine exposure a young earner already has.
Global fund-of-funds	Owens other funds; ₱1,000	Global, but with a second layer of fees, and you cannot see what you own.
Firsts Fund (proposed)	31 companies directly; ₱100	Global, in pesos, one fee, and you can see every company.

A comparison of design, not of returns: ours are simulated, theirs are real.

Sources: PSE investor profile 2024 (via Manila Bulletin, 2025); BPI Wealth. Shuffle test: v4 holdings' monthly results after costs; the result comes from the arithmetic of saving versus withdrawing, not from how high the returns were. 36-year history: Kenneth French Data Library, in pesos.

ONE MESSAGE

Fund your firsts.

Pondohan ang mga una mo. There will always be a new first.

Retirement is too far away for a 22-year-old to picture, and every product already uses it. **A first is different: it has a name, a peso cost and a date.** The fund's holdings support that promise in the background; the details live in the fact sheet and annex.

WHO IT IS FOR

Graduating students and early-career professionals with regular income, a goal at least five years away, and the risk tolerance for a stock fund. Not every beginner: money needed sooner, or emergency savings, belongs elsewhere. Anyone further along with a five-year goal can use it too.

Meet Bea (illustrative). 23, first job as a junior accountant, takes home about ₱28,000 a month .	
Rent and bills	₱8,000
Food	₱7,000
Helping at home	₱4,000
Transport	₱3,000
Emergency savings	₱2,000
Personal	₱2,000
Her first: Japan with her parents in 5 years	₱2,000

CHOOSING A FIRST

Each user starts with **one main first**: picked from suggestions, typed in freely, or found with **“Help me choose my first”**. Saving for several firsts at once is on the roadmap (page 3).

Take Mom and Dad abroad	First car	First home
First business	First time sending money home and keeping some	Something else: type it in

WHY WE BUILD CONFIDENCE, NOT HYPE

A survey of 191 Filipino students (Susada, 2025) found that feeling capable, through knowledge and confidence, was the strongest driver of intending to invest; pressure from friends and family was not. The BSP also measures financial literacy rising (74%, from 69%). So we explain, we do not push: no raffles, cash rewards, leaderboards or countdown timers in the launch. Rewards stay a future idea if costs and approvals allow.

THE GOAL CALCULATOR: THE CENTRE OF THE CAMPAIGN

Name the first, enter the cost and the date (at least five years away). The calculator shows two things side by side, with its assumptions on screen:

Contributions only	₱120,000 ÷ 60 months = ₱2,000 a month . No growth assumed.
With illustrative growth	At an assumed 6% a year, about ₱1,710 a month . An example, not a promise.
Prices rise (optional)	At 4% a year inflation the trip costs about ₱146,000 by then: ₱2,430 a month, contributions only.

Before committing, clear risk information in pesos. Bea's plan (₱2,000 a month for 5 years, ₱120,000 paid in), run through every five-year stretch of our 36-year history (381 of them):

Typical outcome	₱160,000
1 in 20 stretches ended at or below	₱110,000
Worst stretch (ending early 2009)	₱77,000
Worst, with the goal service (page 3)	₱104,000

Industry-level history, after the fee and costs; not a forecast.

WHERE PEOPLE FIND IT: EVERY CHANNEL LEADS TO THE CALCULATOR

Campus talks and caravans	On-site financial-literacy sessions with student organisations, close to graduation.
Early-career workplace sessions	Financial-wellness talks at employers, including companies on BPI payroll, timed with a first job.
Short-form social content	Short, plain videos built on Bea's story; creators support but do not lead, to keep costs down.
BPI App, with “Chat with us”	Online visitors can ask a person before they start.

Launch timing: the 13th month.
Arrives every December and is money no first-jobber budgeted.
“Your 13th month was never in the budget. Give it a first.”
December opens the account; the monthly plan keeps it going.

THE BUSINESS CASE FOR A ₱100 MINIMUM

₱100 at 1.50% earns BPI ₱1.50 a year, so the value is in steady monthly saving. A ₱2,000-a-month plan like Bea's reaches about ₱160,000 in a typical five-year stretch, roughly **₱2,400 a year** in fees. The fund also needs seed money and a minimum size before opening, to cover custody and audit costs. A sketch, not a costed model.

Bea and her budget are illustrative. Calculator growth and inflation rates are example assumptions shown to the user. Sources: Susada (2025), a survey of 191 students at one university, measuring intention to invest rather than actual investing; BSP Consumer Finance and Inclusion Survey 2025.

FIRSTS FUND

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY · THE HABIT: WHAT KEEPS THEM INVESTED

A FinQuest 2026 proposal, not an existing BPI product · Portfolio as of 2 October 2026 · Page 3 of 6

“Fund your firsts.”

WHERE IT LIVES: THE BPI APP

The BPI App is the proposed home for Firsts Fund. Users are already verified there, so opening is a confirmation, not a new application, and pay usually lands in the same bank. All Firsts Fund screens would be new and are labelled as proposed.

SIGN-UP IN FOUR SCREENS

- 1 Confirm identity from the existing BPI record; the standard suitability questions.
- 2 Choose one main first: suggested, typed in, or “Help me choose my first”. A first under five years away gets a suggestion of a better-suited option, such as MP2 or a money market fund.
- 3 See the monthly amount (contributions only, and with illustrative growth) and the risk in pesos.
- 4 Set the monthly plan: amount and payday. Start from ₱100.

HOW MONEY GOES IN

At launch: a regular monthly plan plus top-ups whenever you like. Either one alone is enough to keep a goal on track.

If a month is missed (not enough money, or skipped), the goal date stays the same unless the user changes it. The app shows the missed amount and the updated projection, and offers three choices: a one-off top-up, a higher amount from now on, or a later goal date. Debits are never raised automatically.

WHAT THE USER SEES

Main screen	Total put in · current value · gain or loss in pesos · progress to the goal
Details	Units held, price per unit, every transaction
Reminders	Payday and the goal date, never daily price moves
Reports	In-app progress view; transaction statements; fund reports at least quarterly

No streaks or counters that reset: missing a month should never feel like losing.

HOW WE WOULD KNOW IT WORKED

Measure	Target	Rethink if
Still contributing in month 60	≥ 55%	< 40%
Kept contributing through the first losing quarter	≥ 80%	< 60%
Chose “pause” over “withdraw”	≥ 3 to 1	< 1 to 1
Months contributed in year 1 (median)	≥ 10 of 12	< 7
Reached a first and set a new one	tracked	

Not counted as success: money gathered, accounts opened or app visits. Each can rise while people quietly stop saving.

THE GOAL SERVICE (PROPOSED): WHY AND HOW

Why. Early on, a fall gives a saver time to recover. Close to the goal date there is no time left, so a bad year then can shrink the goal. The fund itself cannot slow down for one person, because everyone in it has a different date.

How. The change happens in the user's own account, not in the fund. Every year the app runs a goal review; two years before the date it sends an extra reminder. The user can then choose to move part of their units into a lower-risk BPI fund. **Nothing moves without their say-so**, and it reduces risk without guaranteeing the goal.

What it can do (Bea's plan, 36-year history, illustrative): the worst five-year stretch improves from ₱77,000 to ₱104,000; the typical outcome is a little lower (₱152,000 vs ₱160,000), the price of less risk. A move to another fund is a future capability that still needs operational checks.

BEFORE SOMEONE WITHDRAWS

WITHDRAW · CONFIRM (proposed screen, example numbers)

₱26,500

You have put in ₱28,000 over 14 months; it is worth ₱26,500 today. You are ₱93,500 from your first: Japan with your parents, October 2031.

Markets are down right now. If you keep saving, you are buying units at a lower price.

[Pause the plan for 3 months] Withdraw ₱26,500

Pausing comes first on screen; withdrawing is still one tap away. No holding period, no exit fee, nothing locked in.

REACHING A FIRST, THEN THE NEXT

When the goal is reached the user can withdraw, or keep the balance invested and name the next first, without starting over. The app suggests a next first at that moment, because there will always be one.

LATER: FUTURE ENHANCEMENTS

Sukli round-ups Spare change from purchases set aside and invested at ₱100. Starts inside the BPI App to test it, before any e-wallet. Needs consent, spending rules and a waiting account to be settled first.

Several firsts at once More than one goal per user, each with its own date and plan.

Rewards Only if the costs and approvals work; the fund must stand without them.

Screens and numbers on this page are proposed and illustrative. Measures and targets are the team's own, to be tested with real data.

FIRSTS FUND

FUND FACT SHEET · PROPOSED ACTIVELY MANAGED GLOBAL EQUITY UITF

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“Fund your firsts.”

FUND OBJECTIVE AND THEME

Objective. Long-term capital growth by investing directly in listed companies around the world that own, operate or supply essential, hard-to-replace capacity: power and water systems, digital networks, ports, airports, hospitals, and the equipment they run on.

How the fund invests, in one line. We identify businesses providing essential capacity, check their financial strength and value, and build a portfolio that balances opportunities with risk. How many companies we hold follows from that process. The fund is **actively managed with diversification and risk controls**; the manager may change holdings and weights within the mandate.

Why it exists. An early-career Filipino earns and saves in pesos, so their future depends on one economy. Firsts Fund would let them own a share of essential businesses around the world from ₱100, in pesos, through a fund that holds the shares directly with a single fee.

Suitable investor. Regular income, a goal at least **five years** away, and the risk tolerance for an equity fund that can fall sharply in a bad year. Not suitable for money needed within five years or for emergency savings.

Goal service (proposed, in the investor's own account). Close to a goal date there is little time to recover from a fall. A yearly goal review, plus a reminder two years before the date, lets the investor choose to move part of their units to a lower-risk fund. Nothing moves without their permission; it changes only their account, not how this fund invests; units are sold at that day's price, and the goal is not guaranteed.

For a regular saver (illustration, not a forecast). ₱1,000 a month for 5 years is ₱60,000 paid in. Across every 5-year stretch from 1990 to 2026 in the industry-level history (381 start months), the typical saver ended with about **₱80,000**. About 1 in 9 stretches ended below ₱60,000; the worst, ending in early 2009, at about ₱39,000. With the proposed goal service, the worst was about ₱52,000.

Same fee and costs; contributions at the start of each month. It reflects the theme, not our company choices.

KEY FACTS

Structure	Global equity UITF (proposed)
Currency	Philippine peso; daily NAVPU
Horizon	5 years or longer
Risk classification	Aggressive
Minimum (proposed)	₱100 to start and per top-up
Fee (proposed)	1.50% a year
All-in cost (est.)	about 2.1% a year, all costs
Buy or sell (proposed)	Any business day; paid T+5; no exit fee
Holdings	31 listed companies, 14 markets
Cash	About 3%, kept to pay redemptions
Limit per company	20% (BSP rule); largest today 5.8%
Benchmark	NFRA global infrastructure ETF, in pesos
Reviews	Holdings monthly; weights quarterly
Trustee	BPI Wealth (proposed)

ALLOCATION BY KIND OF CAPACITY

Digital networks	25.00%
Healthcare facilities	22.19%
Power generation & grids	19.22%
Ports	10.04%
Semiconductors	8.13%
Water	7.68%
Grid & power equipment	2.76%
Airports & toll roads	1.98%
Operating cash	3.00%

By listing market

United States	22.96%
Hong Kong / China	10.98%
Saudi Arabia	10.91%
Germany	8.44%
Thailand	7.28%
Japan	5.56%
Malaysia	5.23%
Philippines	4.80%
6 other markets	20.84%

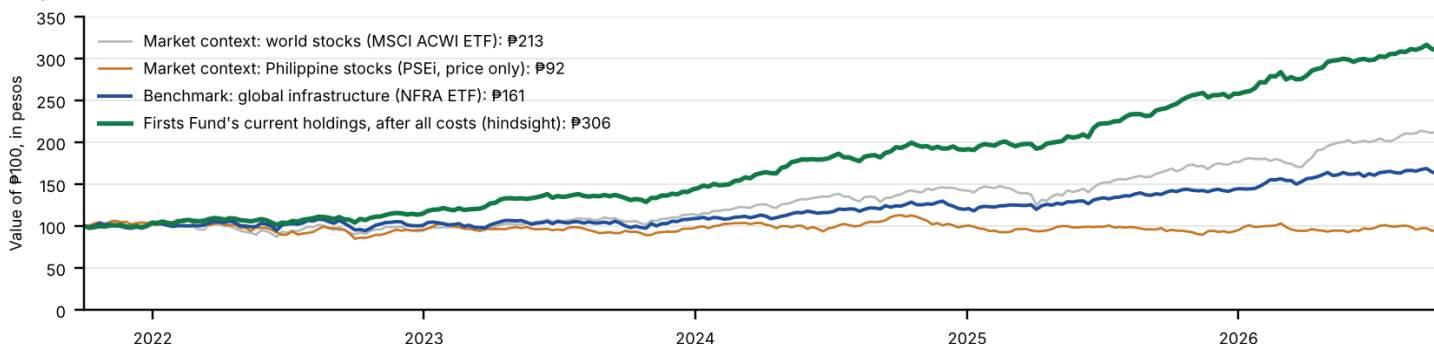
Largest holdings. Exelon 5.8%, Westports 5.2%, ICTSI 4.8%, Engie 4.6%, Bangkok Dusit Medical 4.5%. No company is above 5.8%; all 31 are listed on page 5.

No country quota. Philippine-listed ICTSI is held at 4.80% because it passed the same tests as every other company. Where a company is listed is not always where it earns its revenue.

Shared drivers. About 11% depends on data-centre spending (chips and grid equipment). Digital networks are at the fund's 25% cap per kind of capacity.

PERFORMANCE VS BENCHMARK · PAST RETURNS OF TODAY'S HOLDINGS, IN PESOS · NOT ACTUAL FUND PERFORMANCE

₱100 invested in October 2021 → ₱306 for today's holdings after all costs, vs **₱161** for the benchmark: **25.0% vs 10.0%** a year. **Hindsight: these companies were chosen in October 2026, so this is not a forecast.**



In pesos	2021*	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026*	A year	Volatility	Worst fall
Firsts Fund holdings, after costs	+3.8%	+10.6%	+25.4%	+32.9%	+34.9%	+18.5%	+25.0%	10.2%	−7.4%
Benchmark: NFRA infrastructure ETF	+3.1%	−2.4%	+8.3%	+10.2%	+19.8%	+12.2%	+10.0%	12.4%	−12.6%
Market context: world (MSCI ACWI ETF)	+6.3%	−11.4%	+21.5%	+24.7%	+23.7%	+20.2%	+16.2%	14.8%	−18.2%
Market context: Philippines (PSEI)	+2.7%	−6.8%	+1.7%	+2.8%	−6.3%	−2.0%	−1.7%	13.7%	−21.1%

Also, today's holdings over 5 years: last year +25.4%; last 3 years +32.6% a year · worst 12 months +4.3%, best +52.7% · return for each unit of ups and downs (Sharpe ratio) 2.00 vs 0.45 for the benchmark · moved about 0.59× as much as the benchmark (beta). **In pesos:** the deepest drop on a ₱5,000 balance was ₱372; a bad year like the 36-year worst (−27%) would be ₱1,363.

How to read this. These are past returns of the 31 companies we hold today, after the 1.50% fee, trading costs and dividend taxes; because they were picked knowing how they did, the fund's real results would likely be lower. **Without the 7 chip and grid-equipment companies**, the other 24 returned 18.7% a year (₱100 → ₱237), so the lead over the benchmark does not rest on them alone. **Over the long run:** an industry-level version of the strategy returned 12.0% a year from 1990 to 2026, about the same as the world market (12.2%), with a worst 12 months of −27%. Benchmark and references are ETFs after their own fees. *2021 from 1 Oct; 2026 to 2 Oct.

IMPORTANT. Firsts Fund is a student competition proposal; no such fund exists and nothing here is an offer, solicitation or investment advice. Simulated and historical figures do not represent actual trading. The value of units can fall as well as rise and an investor may get back less than invested. A UITF is not a deposit and is not insured by PDIC.

ALL 31 HOLDINGS · WEIGHTED SO EACH COMPANY ADDS A SIMILAR SHARE OF RISK · AS OF 2 OCTOBER 2026

Holding	Capacity	Weight	% of risk	Holding	Capacity	Weight	% of risk
Exelon	US Power & grids	5.81%	3.9%	Enel	IT Power & grids	2.98%	3.6%
Westports	MY Ports	5.23%	3.8%	Saudi Telecom	SA Digital networks	2.97%	1.9%
ICTSI	PH Ports	4.80%	3.6%	Bharti Airtel	IN Digital networks	2.97%	2.4%
Engie	FR Power & grids	4.57%	3.7%	Deutsche Telekom	DE Digital networks	2.85%	2.4%
Bangkok Dusit Medical	TH Healthcare facilities	4.49%	3.6%	Bumrungrad Hospital	TH Healthcare facilities	2.79%	3.5%
E.ON	DE Power & grids	4.48%	3.7%	Qualcomm	US Semiconductors	2.27%	3.5%
Dr. Sulaiman Al Habib	SA Healthcare facilities	4.41%	3.7%	América Móvil	MX Digital networks	2.01%	2.6%
Guangdong Investment	HK Water	4.36%	3.7%	OMA (airports)	MX Airports & toll roads	1.98%	3.5%
KDDI	JP Digital networks	3.81%	1.8%	Advantest	JP Semiconductors	1.74%	3.4%
Encompass Health	US Healthcare facilities	3.78%	3.8%	HD Hyundai Electric	KR Grid & power equipment	1.65%	3.4%
AT&T	US Digital networks	3.77%	2.3%	NVIDIA	US Semiconductors	1.64%	3.4%
Mouwasat Medical Services	SA Healthcare facilities	3.52%	3.7%	Vistra	US Power & grids	1.38%	3.4%
China Telecom	HK Digital networks	3.33%	2.6%	SK hynix	KR Semiconductors	1.37%	3.4%
Sabesp	BR Water	3.31%	3.6%	Micron	US Semiconductors	1.12%	3.3%
China Mobile	HK Digital networks	3.29%	2.0%	Siemens Energy	DE Grid & power equipment	1.11%	3.4%
HCA Healthcare	US Healthcare facilities	3.19%	3.6%				

Read the risk column, not the weight column. Weights run from 1.1% to 5.8%, but the 23 holdings outside the capped digital networks each carry a similar 3.3%–3.9% of risk: that is the design. NVIDIA gets 1.6% because it swings far more than a hospital operator. The 8 network companies carry less (1.8%–2.6%) because their kind is at the 25% cap. Chips are 8% of the money and 17% of the risk. Together they behave like about 9 independent groups. Weights are reset quarterly; companies we rejected or are watching are in the supporting proposal.

M · V · P: HOW WE BUILD THE PORTFOLIO · 140 COMPANIES SCREENED → 31 HELD · THE SAME PUBLISHED RULES FOR EVERY COMPANY

M

Map the capacity

Find the companies that own, run or supply essential services: up to the 20 largest listed (at least US\$1bn) in each of eight kinds, anywhere in the world. Keep those that earn at least half their revenue from that service and generate cash.

→

140 → 129

140 screened · 129 fit the theme

V

Verify the merit

Check each company is a sound investment: survives a debt stress test sized to its industry, and compares well with its own peers on price and quality; tradeable; sound governance.

→

129 → 49

49 eligible · 35 rejected · 45 on watch

P

Position the risk

Add eligible companies in merit order, only if each one improves diversification. Size them so every holding adds a similar share of risk, within limits: 20% per company or group, 25% per kind of service, about 3% cash.

→

49 → 31

31 held · 18 on watch (added too little diversification)

Judgement sits in the published rules, not in picking favourites. Holdings are reviewed monthly and may be removed after a material event (with the reason logged), but are never resized by hand; weights are reset quarterly. Every company's result is in the supporting proposal.

KEY RISKS	
Market	Share prices can fall sharply. In 36 years of industry-level history the worst 12 months lost 27% and the deepest fall was 44%.
Concentration	Digital networks are at the fund's 25% cap; data-centre spending drives about 11% of the fund but more of its past return (memory-chip makers are near a cyclical peak); Saudi Arabia 11% and US health policy about 7%.
Currency	About 92% is in foreign currencies and not hedged; a stronger peso lowers returns in pesos.
Liquidity	Each holding is kept small enough to sell within a week without moving its price much (sized for a P1bn fund), and about 3% is kept in cash. Many goals may fall due on the same dates (for example December); the manager sees goal dates in advance and can raise cash early.
Country and regulation	Companies in emerging markets, including some partly owned by governments, face policy and sanctions risk.
Selection	Companies are screened with one data provider and thresholds set by the team; the past results shown include hindsight.

FEES AND CHARGES	
Management fee (proposed)	1.50% a year of fund value, accrued daily
Trading costs (modelled)	about 0.21% a year
Dividend withholding (modelled)	about 0.37% a year
Subscription / redemption fee	None proposed
Minimum holding period	None proposed; 5 years+ is a recommendation
Estimated all-in cost	about 2.1% a year

SUBSCRIPTIONS AND REDEMPTIONS (PROPOSED)
Buy units with a one-time amount, a regular monthly plan, or top-ups whenever you like. Sell on any business day at that day's price per unit (NAVPU); the money is paid on day 6, end of day, in line with BPI's peso global equity funds. A missed monthly contribution does not change your goal date and is not taken automatically later.

Compared with other products a young Filipino can buy today: see page 1.

Sources. Company data: stockanalysis.com (S&P Global Market Intelligence), 8 Oct 2026. Prices: Yahoo Finance total returns and PSE Edge (with cash dividends), converted to pesos weekly. Benchmark: FlexShares STOXX Global Broad Infrastructure Index Fund (NFRA), Yahoo Finance adjusted close in pesos; cross-check iShares Global Infrastructure ETF (IGF) returned 13.7% a year. Cash: BSP policy rate minus 0.50 pt. Industry-level history: Kenneth French Data Library and BIS exchange rates. Single-company limit: BSP Circular No. 1234, Series of 2026 (20 May 2026), a 20% ceiling, not a target. Comparison funds: BPI Wealth fund pages and Pag-IBIG. Industry classifications assigned by the team. Dividend tax rates approximate, to be confirmed.

Team Los Angeles 76ers, Ateneo de Manila University: Prince Angelo C. Rivera · Luis Tengonciang · Karol Josef Fuñe · Eric Fabian Thiridy Mendez.

A1 · EVIDENCE BASE: EVERY LOAD-BEARING CLAIM AND ITS SOURCE		
Claim	Figure	Source
Young Filipinos are arriving	18–29 = 26.5% of PSE accounts, from 19.5%; PSE accounts +50.1% in a year	PSE investor profile 2024, via Manila Bulletin (2025)
Access and literacy improved	BPI UITF minimum ₱10,000 → ₱1,000 (2023); 74% answer half the literacy questions, from 69%	BPI Wealth; BSP CFIS 2025
Cash loses in real terms	Inflation 6.2% in July 2026	PSA (2026)
Risk appetite went to crypto	Awareness 20% of adults, from 6%; 46% of owners are 18–34	BSP CFIS 2025; Triple-A
Confidence, not peers, drives investing	Strongest driver $\beta = 0.502$ ($p < .001$); peer pressure not significant	Susada (2025), survey of 191 students
A saver gains from an early fall	Link between a strong start and the final amount: -0.85 saving, $+0.85$ withdrawing	Our shuffle test, 20,000 orders

A2 · WHAT WE KILLED, AND WHY	
“The suitability check is the barrier”	Access clearly improved; the claim argued against its own evidence.
“Participation fell 36% → 23%”	Could not be confirmed from BSP releases; not used.
A fixed 30% Philippines share	No basis. Countries now follow from the same tests (ICTSI 4.8%).
A 10% cash reserve; 16 fixed holdings	About 3% cash covers withdrawals; the count follows from the rules (31).
“Show the bad year first” as its own step	Consultants: balanced risk information, not a scare step. Now in the calculator.
Streaks and a months-funded counter	Replaced by contributions, value, gain or loss and goal progress.
Sukli at launch, through e-wallets	A future enhancement, tested inside the BPI App first.
Automatic glidepath with set transfer rates	The user decides, after a yearly review; no promised schedule or protection.
A blanket “non-tech” label	Technology exposure is assessed, not excluded (chips 8%).

A6 · WHAT WOULD CHANGE OUR MIND

The shuffle result is arithmetic. But the case rests on people **continuing to contribute**, modelled as 60 uninterrupted monthly payments, which no source we found measures for this group. If people stop much more often, the fund's risk level should come down. How often people keep going through a losing year is the first thing we would test with real data, and the honest weak point of this proposal.

A3 · BACK-TEST METHOD AND ITS LIMITS	
Method. Weekly peso returns including dividends, 1 Oct 2021 – 2 Oct 2026. Each quarter, weights were set using only the previous three years of prices, under every limit (21 times). After the 1.50% fee, 0.30% trading cost and dividend taxes. Benchmark NFRA, in pesos.	
Selection is hindsight	Companies chosen in Oct 2026 with Oct 2026 data, priced backwards. Upper bound.
Survivorship	Universe is today's largest companies; failures since 2021 are missing.
One cycle	Chips are 8% of the money but 17% of the risk, near a cyclical peak; without chips and grid equipment, 18.7% a year.
Tax estimate	Dividend tax rates are approximate; to be confirmed by a tax adviser.

The first three make the figures look better than reality. We do not adjust for them; the 36-year industry history is our “what to expect”. Withdrawals and goal-service moves are ordinary sales of units, paid from cash first and then by selling shares, at the 0.30% trading cost.

A4 · LIMITS: RULE VS TODAY (ALL MET AT EVERY QUARTERLY RESET)		
Limit	Rule	Actual
One company	≤ 20% (BSP)	5.81%
One group (e.g. Razon)	≤ 20%	4.80%
One kind of capacity	≤ 25%	25.00%
Liquidity	sell in 5 days at 20% of volume	never binds at ₱1bn
Operating cash	about 3%	3.00%
Country quota	none	Philippines 4.80% (3.2%–5.3%)

Concentration, disclosed: the 31 holdings behave like about 9 independent groups; the two biggest common influences explain 25% of the ups and downs. Holdings outside the capped networks each carry 3.3–3.9% of the risk.

A5 · REGULATORY POSITION	
The fund. A peso UITF holding foreign shares directly, priced daily (NAVPU), with a 20% single-company ceiling per BSP Circular No. 1234 (2026). Our reading, not reviewed by counsel; any launch would need that review first.	
Suitability. We are not asking BPI to relax the Client Suitability Assessment, to allow an education-based override, or to sell an aggressive fund to a client rated conservative. We propose recording the investor's horizon and contribution plan in the suitability file, with an audit trail, and letting the goal service carry risk down as the date approaches.	
Sukli (future). Starts inside the BPI App. Needs clear, revocable consent, rules on which purchases count, and a regulated place for spare change to wait before it is invested; e-wallets only after that works and partner agreements exist.	
Reports. Separate in-app progress view, transaction statements, and fund disclosures, with fund reports at least quarterly.	